

Vertigo

No 811 October 2017



NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB

Wellington Section Monthly Bulletin

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Chair's Report

October 2017

A brief suggestion of summer this month inspired me to dream of long days in the mountains. Dipping into clear chilled streams and swatting away sand flies. But then I saw the film Mountain. An interesting exploration into the interaction between our species and the mountain environment. A short clip in the film of an endless queue winding its way up Mt Everest brought me back to reality and reminded me of similar images of the Tongariro Crossing and descriptions of the Te Araroa Trail.

Tourist numbers are continuing to rise in New Zealand and globally yet, typically of the species, we are much more reactive than proactive and so infrastructure and management lag well behind the need. This isn't just in relation to sanitation, which I've written about before, but also the quality of the experience. Most of the Great Walks now have booking systems, some all year round. This arguably provides a sufficient mechanism to manage and maintain the walks. But what about the rest of the country? We can't put a fence around every track. Well we could, but that isn't cost efficient. The pay on entry solution appears to be the most appropriate approach. But it isn't sufficient unless those resources are ring fenced for 'park' management. What attracts people is the quality of our natural environment. We want to prevent it from being degraded. We also want our families and kids to be able to benefit from the experience of exploring wilderness, while it's still wilderness. Unless we act now to change the situation the queues are only going to get bigger, as will the impact on the environment. We have some very special places in New Zealand, let's not succumb to short term greed and inaction and keep them special.

If you have any comments on what you like or don't like send an email to wellington@alpineclub.org.nz or tweet us [@NZACWellington](https://twitter.com/NZACWellington).

Simon

"One of the things that limits our learning is our belief that we already know something."
David Marquet

From the Editor

Thanks to those who sent feedback about our new Vertigo format. One good point was raised that I want to highlight - we need more trip reports! All you need to do is type up a report of between half a page to three pages as a Word document, email it to me at occasionalclimber@gmail.com with one to six jpeg images and I'll format it for Vertigo.

Don't forget the page quicklinks at the base of each page - they let you go straight to the page you want rather than having to scroll back and forth all the time.

Peter

Simon Williamson
Chair: NZAC Wellington

Section News

September Section night

About 20 people attended the Outdoor Photography session at our last Section night. For those who are interested in the subject but couldn't make it, you can see the presentation [here](#).



October Section night

The AGM for the Wellington Section of the NZ Alpine Club will take place during our section night on Wednesday 25th October 2017 at the Tuatara Third Eye, 2nd floor, 30 Arthur Street, Wellington, from 6pm.

Don't worry though, the business stuff won't drag on. As the main event, John Palmer, incoming NZAC President, will share his thoughts about "RIP New Zealand climbing. Died: 2017. Cause of death: No access"

You are invite to nominate yourself or others for the following committee positions:

- Chair
- Treasurer
- Secretary
- Section night coordinator
- Club liaison
- Social media coordinator
- Trip coordinator
- Gear custodian
- Event coordinator (s)
- Summer Rock director
- Winter course director
- General committee members

Please forward your nominations to wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

November Section night

Dave Eaton, survivor of a serious climbing accident will tell his story, during the fall and afterwards, both physically and mentally. He will talk about preparedness with gear, planning and mental processes required to manage and get through a dire situation. Tme permitting, he will also talk about aspects that could contribute to such an accident taking place.



Section News

Gear Hire

Don't forget the Section has gear for hire: avalanche transceivers, ice axes, shovels, stakes, hammers, helmets, crampons, probes, PLBs, ice hammers (entry level).

To hire gear please fill in the form [here](#).

Each item costs \$5 per week with the exception of PLBs – PLBs are free but require a deposit of \$50 refundable on return.

A little bit of advance notice would be appreciated as gear often needs to be retrieved from the gear store in Lower Hutt. Gear collections and drop-offs are usually available in the city during the working day or at section night.

Accommodation on Mt Ruapehu

Our snowcraft courses for the past few years have been run out of the Manawatu Tramping and Skiing Club lodge on Whakapapa. We're always made to feel welcome and the lodge is well situated a short walk from the top of the Bruce Road. Membership to the club is extremely reasonable - \$35 per year or \$50 for a family membership. Members stay at the lodge for \$36 a night including food. If you're looking for somewhere to base yourself for your winter pursuits or rock-climbing over the summer months go to www.mtsc.org.nz/joining.php to find out more about joining the club.



Heading to Mt Cupola, Nelson Lakes

Notices

Can you identify them?

National Office has been asked for help to ID the guys in these pictures. Find out more [here](#).

UIAA ice climbing season

The provisional calendar for the 2018 UIAA Ice Climbing season is now in place. Read [more](#).

2017 Mountain Protection Award

The 2017 Mountain Protection Award has just announced 26 projects from 15 countries who have applied - to see what other countries are doing read [more](#).

High Alpine Skills Courses

Mostly full, however still applications for waitlist. Read [more](#).

NZAC Summer Photography workshop

Aimed at beginner-intermediate photographers wanting to improve their outdoor photography skills. Read [more](#).

NZRA Awards

Read [more](#).

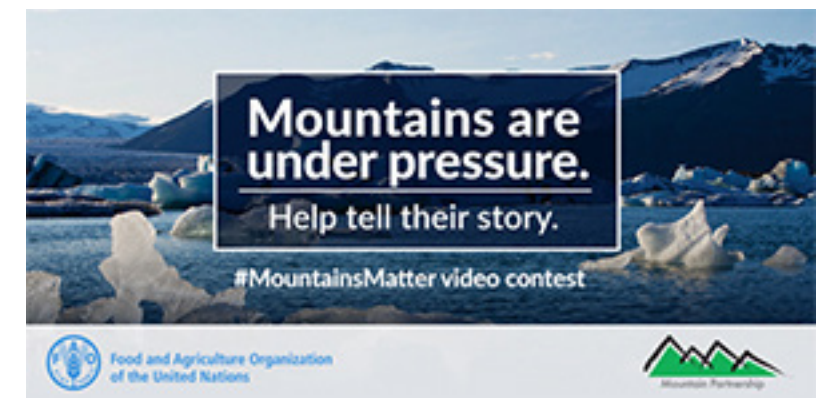
#MountainsMatter video contest

To bring attention to the plight of mountains for International Mountain Day (11 December), make a one-minute video on the theme of 'Mountains under pressure: climate, hunger, migration' for the #MountainsMatter video contest. The deadline for entries is 20 October 2017. Find out [more](#).

No ordinary Shelia

In NZ cinemas from October 19.

Locations playing the film can be found [here](#).



Don't forget

If you have one of the following emails you need to update it with your new one on the NZAC database when Vodafone shuts your old one down on 30th November.

vodafone.co.nz	ihug.co.nz
quik.co.nz	paradise.net.nz
wave.co.nz	es.co.nz
clear.net.nz	pcconnect.co.nz
vodafone.net	

Coming Trips, Courses, Events

All our planned South Island trips come with the added bonus that rental vehicle costs for Wellington Section members are covered by the Section.

If you're uncertain about the skill level required with any of the trips, would like to register your interest or to find out more, email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Also, please contact us if you're keen to run a trip yourself – the Committee can help with advertising and logistics.

When	Where
14 and 21 November Two screenings on consecutive Tuesdays, commencing 6pm	Reel Rock - back for a second year by popular demand. Nga Taonga Sound & Vision Cinema, 84 Taranaki St Tickets \$19 members, \$21 non members, \$14 Under 15s Get in quick, cinema seats 107 only. Book your tickets: For Tuesday 14 Nov here For Tuesday 21 Nov here Please note - we're using Eventopia to process all bookings online. Eventopia applies a handling fee per ticket of between \$1.60 and \$1.78
November	Aspiring Take 2, details coming soon
2 - 6 February 2018	The National Climbing Camp, Tukino, based at TASC Lodge

Outdoor Training NZ Courses

OTNZ Wellington is running training courses as follows:

Navigation (6 and 11 November)

In depth course to teach skills and knowledge to enable safe navigation both in the bush and above the bushline.

River Safety (3 December)

Course covers understanding river dynamics and hazards, how to evaluate sites for safe crossing, methods of crossing, preparing clothing and equipment for a crossing, managing a group crossing, pack floating and how to self-rescue if swept away.

More information on these courses and how to book your place can be found at www.outdoortraining.nz/courses/courses.php.

Trip Reports

Post Snowcraft trip

Words Luke Whitehead, photographs Simon Williamson

The slopes of Ruapehu glistened in front of us as we trudged along the ridge. A firm snowpack beneath our feet made walking easy, but the sun was beating down on us and there wasn't a breath of wind.

This wasn't the weather we were expecting. When we met in the Third Eye last week, we'd considered cancelling the trip after seeing the gloomy forecast. We had decided to continue on the basis that we could still practice our skills near the relative safety of the hut. This trip was the follow up to the Snowcraft courses run just a few weeks ago, and I looked forward to the opportunity to spend time on the snow and ice. We were a group of just five: two of us, Greg and I, participants in the intermediate course, along with Alex, Simon and Caroline, all instructors in those courses.



With a grim forecast for the weekend ahead, we weren't expecting the mountain to offer us many opportunities to explore, so it was with mixed feelings about the weekend that we made our way up to Ruapehu Hut from the Whakapapa carpark on a cold Friday night. Imagine our surprise, then, when we woke up the next morning blinded by sunlight coming through the windows - it was a beautiful day outside. We hastily packed our bags and started our climb through the ski field. It was a warm day, and the ascent was tiring - but we were driven by the sight of ominous grey clouds below us. We continued on with our sights set on the Dome... but of course, as is typical of trips to Ruapehu, the weather came in as soon as we reached the top of the ridge. We lost our views of the Summit Plateau and Crater Lake as we ate our lunch by the ice-covered Dome shelter, yet we were determined that the weather would not hamper our morale.



Practising anchor placement and belaying

At this point, the group split - Greg was feeling unwell and needed to get off the tops. Alex, Simon and I descended (with a slide) into the summit plateau and sized up the slopes around us. Our aim was to set up a few pitches to get some more experience using ropes on the snow. I made my way up a short slope, roped up, and started setting up an anchor. After a minute spent hammering in a stake and setting up a solid place to stand, I stopped to think about how I would secure myself and belay Simon up. Only five weeks have gone by since the intermediate Snowcraft course, yet I'd already forgotten what I was doing. This was a stark reminder of just how quickly you forget the small details when you don't practice - small details that could make all the difference on a climb. I set up what I could and belayed Simon up to me, at which point I found out what I had done wrong - the list is too long to include here.

Thankfully, that was what this trip was all about, and the gentle slope into the summit plateau meant the consequences were not severe if something had gone wrong. Grateful for the help, I gave it another go later, with slightly more success. We continued doing this for a short while, occasionally getting a fleeting glimpse through the clouds out over the summit plateau. The slippery slope beneath us meant I had a go at self arresting a few more times than expected, which, of course, was also good practice.



Abseil practise

We eventually packed away our ropes and made our way back down. The snow was softer now, a perfect layer of powder, and I jealously looked towards the skiers in the distance. We slid down to the hut just as the sun came out again. A relaxing evening in the hut included more opportunities to practice rope work, and I slowly started to remember more and more parts of the course.

We didn't have the same luck with the weather the next morning, so we weren't in a rush to get moving. We decided to just stick to the slopes around Delta corner, given that it was lightly snowing and visibility was reduced, with gale-force winds in the forecast. We spent the morning abseiling and climbing over mixed rock and ice, in a spot sheltered from the wind, which was a great way to round off the weekend.



Luke and Alex Waterworth making good use of hut time

After having a leisurely lunch and cleaning the hut, and with a cautious eye on the skies above, it was an easy walk back down to the carpark. All in all, it was a fantastic time and I learnt a lot. Having the opportunity to learn from three excellent instructors was a real privilege. Looking back, I've come to realise just how important it is to follow up on the Snowcraft courses with trips like these. While the courses are full of invaluable content, it is only by getting out there, making mistakes and learning from them that the skills can really be learnt.

Section Contacts

Powered by volunteers

We're always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. A lot goes on to keep our club going, virtually all powered by volunteers. On the back page is our "Club on a page" summary. It gives an at a glance description of all the things we do, how and why. Feel free to print a copy and pass it on to anyone who might be interested in becoming a member or volunteer. And if you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Position	Name	Contact
Chair person	Simon Williamson	021 054 7684
Co Chair	Eric Duggan	021 350 161
Secretary	Carolyn Ellis	021 574 287
Treasurer	Vacant	
Section nights, Vertigo	Peter Laurenson	021 446 725
Patron	John Nankervis	
Social media, Projects	Elisha Watson	
Projects	Matt Pemberton	
Projects	Sandy Britain	
Library, Projects	Alex Waterworth	
Rock drill overseer	Jeremy Tries	027 555 5893

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www.fergskayaks.co.nz

Open 7 Days

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Alpine Club members can climb any time for \$12
Monday nights show your Alpine Club card and climb for \$10

New routes every week*

\$1000 worth of new holds in Jan/Feb 2012
New pad in "Da Cave" allowing safe aggressive bouldering

Creating happiness through better climbing

* to be precise, this is just an average but we do aim for new routes every single week.

HangDog Rock Climbing Adventures
453 Hutt Rd
Lower Hutt
(04) 589 9181
info@hangdog.co.nz

www.hangdog.co.nz

i climb .co.nz

Simond alpine equipment direct from the importer

Ocelot
\$115

MXC 820
\$230

Makalu
\$255

Caiman
\$230

all crampons include anti-balling plates and crampon bag

i climb .co.nz

For quick access to our Section's page on the NZAC website, click or scan this QR code



WHAT WE DO

FOR MEMBERS

Facilities

- * Huts
- * Gear
- * Library
- * Discounts

Training

- * Level 1- 3
winter skills
- * Summer rock
- * Instructors

Climbing trips

- * Section
- * National
- * International

FOR MEMBERS AND WIDER PUBLIC

Publications

- * Website
- * Social media
- * Vertigo
- * Guide books

Events

- * Banff mountain
film festival
- * Reel Rock
- * Photo comp

Networking

- * Section nights
- * Conferences
and meetings
- * Lobbying

HOW WE DO IT

Organise, encourage, support, enable

Inform, entertain, promote

OUR RESOURCES

Volunteer time and capabilities, income from events and gear hire, national office support, sponsorship

WHY WE DO IT

Connecting & developing more climbing & mountaineering people, knowledge, skills & experience, thereby ...

... building
lifelong
friendships

... protecting
and improving
access to
alpine places

... sustaining
and growing
climbing and
mountaineering
achievement

... enhancing
alpine
safety

... building
appreciation,
enjoyment and
protection of
alpine places